election, in that sense, provided the deeper foundation for the 2019 poll campaign. The drive itself had been predicated on two major pillars.

The first was the Vistarak Yojana (Expander Scheme), which began in April 2017 from Naxalbari in West Bengal, where the Naxalite movement had begun in 1967. The yojana encompassed thousands of party workers—characterised as vistaraks—who agreed to spend between fifteen days, six months or a year in specific booths. The party claims that 2,77,922 vistaraks committed to fifteen-day booth visits.[35]

The second was the Shakti Kendra Yojana, which involved the setting up of cluster heads to supervise four–five voting booths each. The party held over 150 cluster meetings and organised 482 election-organisation committees for the national campaign, manned by 7,830 workers. Almost 3,000 party workers worked full-time and without a salary in 2,566 assembly constituencies for about two years.

A significant part of Narendra Modi's personal election campaign in 2019 was focused on booth-level workers through the NaMo app, as part of a programme called 'Mera Booth Sab Se Mazboot' (My Booth Is the Strongest). Away from the media glare, Modi held live video interactions with booth-level workers in almost every Lok Sabha constituency—in clusters of five each—through the NaMo app in the months leading up to the campaign. As part of these video meetings, the BJP claimed that Modi interacted in 2019 with over 10,000 BJP workers and over 7,000 beneficiaries of Union government schemes like the Jan Dhan Yojana or Ujjwala.[36]

The final thrust of the campaign included using the party's ground-level structures for outreach to beneficiaries of government-funded social-welfare programmes. For this, the BJP set up 161 call centres in 2019, manned by 15,862 callers, most of whom were party workers. Between them, they specifically targeted 24 crore 81 lakh beneficiaries who had gained from government programmes.[37] While the call centres targeted them through phone calls, the party's booth-level workers worked on reaching them directly. This outreach culminated on 26 February 2019 with an announcement by the BJP that it had organised a nationwide programme wherein lamps had